Ailin Zhang (张爱琳)

CONTACT INFORMATION

London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE)
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ailin1998.github.io

FIELDS

Primary: Urban Economics
Secondary: Labor Economics, Real Estate Economics

DOCTORAL STUDIES

PhD in Economic Geography, LSE — expected 2027
Supervisors: Gabriel Ahlfeldt and Christian Hilber

References

Professor Gabriel Ahlfeldt
Humboldt University of Berlin
School of Business and Economics
+49 (0)30 2093 5713
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Professor Christian Hilber
London School of Economics and Political Science
Department of Geography and Environment
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Professor Yanos Zylberberg
University of Bristol
School of Economics
+44 117 455 8671
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PRIOR EDUCATION

MSc in Real Estate Economics and Finance, LSE (Distinction) — 2021

BA in Finance, Renmin University of China (GPA: 3.71/4.00) — 2020

Business Administration Exchange, LMU Munich (GPA: 4.00/4.00) — 2019

WORKING PAPERS

"Cities as Portfolios" (JMP) [Draft]

"Housing Constraints and Intergenerational Mobility" [Draft]

"The Economics of Architecture" *with Gabriel Ahlfeldt and Elisabetta Pietrostefani*. Revise and Resubmit, *Journal of Urban Economics* [CEPRDP21022]

"Internal Migration Liberalization and Productivity" [Draft]

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Volatile Cities, Mobile People"

TEACHING EXPERIENCE (GTA)

GY210 The Economics of Cities, LSE	2025/26
GY314 Economics of Housing Markets and Migration, LSE	2023/24–2024/25
GY350 Undergraduate Dissertation Support, LSE	2023/24–2024/25
GY457 Applied Urban and Real Estate Economics, LSE (one guest seminar)	2023/24
GY209 Economic Geography of Trade and Development, LSE	2023/24

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Referee: Regional Science and Urban Economics

Service: Co-organizer, LSE Quantitative Spatial Models Reading Group 2024/25

AWARDS

LSE PhD Studentship	2022–2026
MSc REEF Best Dissertation, LSE	2021
MSc REEF Best Overall Performance, LSE	2021
Renmin University of China First–Class Scholarship	2019

PRESENTATIONS & CONFERENCES

2026 Urban Planning and Livability Workshop (Copenhagen, Jan.), UEA European (Barcelona, May), Workshop in Urban Economics and Economic Geography, University of Reading (June), RIEF Doctoral Meeting (Paris, June), Zurich–Bern–Wisconsin Conference on Real Estate and Urban Economics (Bern, June), Zurich–Oxford Doctoral Symposium on Real Estate Markets (Oxford, Sep.)

2025 13th Warwick Economics PhD Conference (June), Workshop in Urban Economics and Economic Geography, University of Reading (June)

2023 Urban Labor Markets Workshop (IAB Nuremberg, Nov.), ECRC Cambridge (May)

SKILLS

Software: Stata, MATLAB, Python, QGIS

Languages: Mandarin (native), English (fluent)

Last updated: October 28, 2026